Ember Coffee Co.

Brand book and brand pack

Voice, colour, type, wording, product facts, warranty, policies and terms.
Version 3.0, October 2026. For staff, agencies and partners.

Ember Coffee Co. Ltd, Unit 4, Foundry Yard, Leeds LS9 8AB, United Kingdom.
hello@embercoffee.example · Internal and partner use only.

CONTENTS

What is in this book

Page	Section	What it covers
3	Who we are	Brand description, story, what we sell and to whom
4	Vision, mission and goals	Where we are going and how we measure it
5	Brand theme and personality	The idea behind everything: the first warm hour of the day
6	Voice and tone	How Ember sounds, with tone by situation
7	Wording	Words we use, words we never use, claims we can and cannot make
8	Colour themes	Primary and secondary palette, ratios, pairings
9	Typography	Font families, styles, sizes and hierarchy
10	Imagery and poster rules	Photography, illustration, poster copy limits
11	Products and facts	The range, roast schedule, tasting notes, freshness
12	Warranty	Brewing equipment warranty and how to claim
13	Policies	Delivery, returns, subscriptions, privacy, sustainability
14	Terms and conditions	The terms that govern sales through our shop
15	Approvals and contacts	Who signs off what, and how to reach us

This book replaces version 2.2 (March 2025). Where an older document disagrees with this one, this one wins. Questions go to the brand team at brand@embercoffee.example.

How to use this book

- Copywriters and agencies: read pages 5 to 7 and page 10 before writing anything.
- Designers: pages 8 to 10 are your rules. The colour values are exact; please do not eyeball them.
- Customer care and legal: pages 11 to 14 are the facts and terms we stand behind.
- Anyone writing a poster: the copy limits on page 10 are hard limits, not suggestions.

WHO WE ARE

Brand description

Ember Coffee Co. is a small-batch coffee roaster from Leeds. We roast dark, bold coffee for people who need their mornings to be a little kinder. We sell whole-bean and ground coffee, a coffee subscription, and a short range of brewing equipment through our own online shop, our roastery café on Foundry Yard, and around forty independent cafés and grocers in the north of England.

We started in 2019 with one second-hand 5 kg roaster in a railway arch. We still roast every batch by hand, every Monday, and we still taste every batch before it is bagged. We are a team of fourteen people.

> *“Coffee that makes mornings less rude.”*

What we sell

- **Coffee:** four year-round roasts and one rotating seasonal roast, in 250 g and 1 kg bags.
- **Subscription:** coffee delivered every one, two or four weeks, always roasted that week.
- **Brewing equipment:** the Hearth pour-over kit, the Kindling hand grinder and the Stoker gooseneck kettle.
- **Wholesale:** coffee, training and equipment for independent cafés.

Who we sell to

Our core customer is someone aged 25 to 45 who brews at home before work, cares about taste more than origin stories, and has no time for coffee snobbery. They want a good cup quickly. They are loyal once won, and they tell their friends. Our second audience is independent café owners who want a dependable dark roast and a supplier who picks up the phone.

What makes us different

- We roast dark on purpose and do it well. Most specialty roasters go light; we do not apologise for liking chocolate and smoke.
- Freshness is a promise, not a slogan. Every bag shows its roast date, and nothing leaves us older than seven days.
- We are friendly, not fancy. No jargon, no lectures, no tasting-note poetry nobody can taste.

VISION, MISSION AND GOALS

Where we are going

Vision

> *A better first hour of the day, in every kitchen we reach.*

We believe the first hour sets the tone for the rest of the day. If we can make that hour a bit warmer, a bit easier and a bit more delicious, we have done something worth doing.

Mission

To roast bold, honest coffee that is easy to brew well at home, deliver it fresh, and treat every customer like a regular.

Values

Value	What it means	What it looks like
Warmth	We are kind first.	Customer care replies like a friend, not a script.
Honesty	We only say what we can prove.	No certifications we do not hold. Roast dates on every bag.
Craft	Small batches, done by hand, tasted every time.	Every Monday batch is cupped before it is bagged.
Ease	Great coffee should not need a manual.	Brew guides fit on one card. Equipment works out of the box.

Goals for 2027

Goal	Measure	Target
Grow the subscription	Active subscribers	6,000 by December 2027 (from 3,400)
Keep it fresh	Bags shipped within 7 days of roast	99%
Win more cafés	Wholesale partners	60 (from 41)
Be easy to deal with	Customer care first reply	Under 4 working hours
Waste less	Packaging that is home-compostable or recyclable	100% of retail bags by mid-2027

BRAND THEME AND PERSONALITY

The first warm hour

Everything Ember makes comes back to one theme: **the first warm hour of the day**. Early light through a kitchen window. The kettle going. Steam off a cup. The quiet before the day starts asking for things. Our name is the glow that is still there in the morning, the bit of fire that gets the day going again.

Theme in practice

- Settings are homes, kitchens, small cafés and early streets, never offices or boardrooms.
- Light is warm and low: sunrise, lamp light, window light. Never cold blue light or harsh flash.
- People, when shown, are alone or in pairs, relaxed, half-awake, real. Never posed groups toasting with mugs.
- Steam and glow are our signature details. Use them, but do not overdo them.

Personality

If Ember were a person, they would be the friend who is already up when you stagger into the kitchen, hands you a cup without asking, and makes a gentle joke about your hair.

We are	We are not
Warm	Gushing or saccharine
Playful	Silly, sarcastic or mean
A little cheeky	Rude, edgy or crude
Confident	Smug or superior about coffee
Plain-spoken	Corporate, technical or jargon-heavy
Grounded	Precious, luxury or exclusive

Taglines in use

- “Coffee that makes mornings less rude.” (primary)
- “Roasted Monday. Yours by Thursday.” (subscription)
- “Strong enough to nudge your day along.” (Night Shift)

VOICE AND TONE

How Ember sounds

Our voice stays the same everywhere. Our tone shifts with the moment. The voice is: **warm, playful, a little cheeky**. Short lines. We talk to one person, not a crowd. We never sound like a bank.

Five voice rules

- **Talk to one person.** Write “you”, not “customers” or “coffee lovers everywhere”.
- **Keep it short.** If a sentence needs a comma and an “and”, it probably wants to be two sentences.
- **Be cheeky, never mean.** Tease the morning, never the reader.
- **Say the plain thing.** “Tastes like dark chocolate”, not “notes of cacao-forward complexity”.
- **Never sound like a bank.** No “valued customer”, “leverage”, “solutions” or “please be advised”.

Tone by situation

Situation	Tone	Example
Poster or social	Most playful	Wake up, lovely. Night Shift has your back.
Product page	Warm and clear	Bold and smooth, with dark chocolate and a little orange peel.
Order emails	Friendly and brief	It's roasted, bagged and on its way. Kettle on Thursday?
Customer complaint	Warm, serious, no jokes	That should not have happened. Here is what we will do today.
Legal and policy	Plain and precise	You can return unopened coffee within 14 days.

Before and after

Not like this	Like this
Experience our premium artisanal dark roast blend.	Meet Night Shift. Our darkest, boldest bag.
We apologise for any inconvenience caused.	Sorry. That's on us, and we'll fix it.
Valued customers can now leverage our subscription solution.	Never run out again. We'll send it fresh.

WORDING

Words we use and words we never use

Words we never use

These words and claims must never appear in any Ember copy, in any channel, in any language:

- **Cheap.** We are good value. We are never cheap.
- **Fair trade.** We are not Fairtrade certified, so we never use the phrase, with or without capitals.
- **Organic.** We are not certified organic, so we never say or imply it.
- **World's best** (and “best coffee in the world”, “number one”). We cannot prove it, so we do not say it.

We are not certified fair trade or organic. Saying so would be untrue and, in the UK, unlawful. If a partner or customer asks, the honest answer is on page 13 (Sustainability).

Claims we can make

Claim	Why we can make it
Roasted every Monday in small batches	True; recorded in the roast log
Ships within 7 days of roasting	True; we track it for every order
Roasted by hand in Leeds	True; one roastery, one roaster team
Bold, dark, smooth	Descriptive taste words, not factual claims
Best within 30 days of roast	Our own freshness guidance, printed on every bag

Words we like

Warm, bold, smooth, glow, kettle, morning, fresh, roast, nudge, wake, cosy, steady, first cup, Monday, small batch, kind, easy.

Words to avoid

Premium, luxury, artisanal, curated, elevate, indulge, experience (as a verb), solution, leverage, utilise, valued customer, synergy, game-changer, superfood, energy boost, healthy.

Spelling and style

- British English: colour, flavour, favourite, cosy.
- Our name is “Ember Coffee Co.” on first mention, then “Ember”. Never “EMBER” or “Ember Coffee Company”.
- Product names in title case, no quotes: Night Shift, First Light, Hearth pour-over kit.
- Weights as “250 g” with a space. Prices as “£9.50”. Dates as “14 October 2026”.
- No exclamation marks in headlines. At most one per email.

COLOUR THEMES

The Ember palette

Our palette comes from the theme: glowing coals, roasted beans, crema and morning light. Ember Orange and Roast Brown are the brand. The others support them. Use the hex values exactly.

Primary colours

Ember Orange #c2541c
Primary. Our spark.
Logo, headlines, buttons, key accents. The colour people should remember. RGB 194 84 28.

Roast Brown #4a2e1f
Primary. Our ground.
Backgrounds, body text on light surfaces, packaging base. RGB 74 46 31.

Secondary colours

Crema #f5ece0
Light neutral.
Page backgrounds and calm space. Our white. RGB 245 236 224.

Morning Gold #e3a33b
Accent.
Highlights, seasonal roast labels, small details only. RGB 227 163 59.

Charcoal #1f1a17
Dark neutral.
Long-form text, dark mode backgrounds. RGB 31 26 23.

Steam Grey #b9b2aa
Soft neutral.
Dividers, disabled states, secondary labels. RGB 185 178 170.

Ratios and pairings

- Roughly 60% Crema or Roast Brown as ground, 30% the other neutral, 10% Ember Orange. Orange is the glow, not the room.
- Morning Gold never covers more than 5% of a layout and never sits directly on Ember Orange.
- Text pairings that pass contrast: Roast Brown on Crema, Crema on Roast Brown, Charcoal on Crema, white on Ember Orange at 18 pt or larger.
- Never put Ember Orange text on Roast Brown at body size. It is hard to read.
- In photography and image prompts, describe the scene in Ember Orange and Roast Brown tones with soft warm light.

TYPOGRAPHY

Font styles

We use two typefaces. Fraunces gives us warmth and a bit of character. Inter keeps everything else clear. Both are free under the SIL Open Font License, so partners can use them without a licence fee.

Font families

Family	Role	Weights we use	Fallback
Fraunces	Headlines, taglines, product names on packaging	SemiBold 600, Bold 700, Italic 400 for pull quotes	Georgia, serif
Inter	Body copy, UI, labels, legal text	Regular 400, Medium 500, SemiBold 600	Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif

Type scale (digital)

Style	Family and weight	Size / line height	Use
Display	Fraunces Bold	48 / 52 px	Hero headlines, posters
H1	Fraunces SemiBold	32 / 38 px	Page titles
H2	Fraunces SemiBold	24 / 30 px	Section titles
H3	Inter SemiBold	18 / 26 px	Card titles, product names in UI
Body	Inter Regular	16 / 26 px	All running text
Small	Inter Medium	13 / 20 px	Labels, captions, roast dates
Legal	Inter Regular	12 / 18 px	Terms, footnotes

Rules

- Headlines in sentence case: “Wake up, lovely”, not “Wake Up, Lovely”.
- Never set body text in Fraunces, and never set headlines in all capitals.
- Letter spacing: Display –1%, everything else default. Small labels may be +4% in capitals for roast dates only.
- Left-align text. Centre only on posters and the packaging front.
- On posters, one typeface per line and no more than three type sizes in total.
- Print packaging: headline minimum 14 pt, ingredients and legal minimum 7 pt.

IMAGERY AND POSTER RULES

Pictures and posters

Photography

- Warm, natural light: early morning window light, lamp light or sunrise. Shadows are welcome.
- Subjects: a single steaming cup, hands around a mug, a kettle mid-pour, beans in a scoop, a kitchen counter at dawn.
- Colour grade toward Ember Orange and Roast Brown. Keep whites slightly warm, never blue.
- Textures: wood, ceramic, linen, enamel. Avoid glass-and-steel offices and glossy studio sets.
- Never show coffee being spilled, burnt or wasted, and never show anyone drinking while driving.

Illustration

Simple line illustrations in Roast Brown with one Ember Orange accent (usually steam or a glow). No gradients, no 3D renders, no mascots.

Poster copy limits

Every poster has a headline, a subheadline and a short body. These limits are hard limits:

Element	Limit	Example
Headline	Up to 6 words	Wake up, lovely
Subheadline	Up to 12 words	Coffee that makes mornings less rude
Body	Up to 25 words	Bold Night Shift, smooth enough to sip, strong enough to nudge your day along.

Poster rules

- The picture never contains words. All copy goes in the copy layer, never in the image or the image prompt.
- Use the colours Ember Orange and Roast Brown when you describe the picture.
- One product per poster. Name it once.
- Never claim fair trade, organic, world's best or cheap, on a poster or anywhere else.
- Logo bottom right, at least 8% of poster width, with clear space equal to the height of the “E”.
- Every poster gets sign-off from the brand team before it goes out (page 15).

PRODUCTS AND FACTS

The range

These facts are the only product facts copy may use. If it is not here, check with the brand team before using it.

Coffee

Product	Roast	Tasting notes	Sizes and price
Night Shift	Dark	Dark chocolate, orange peel	250 g £9.50, 1 kg £32.00
First Light	Medium-dark	Toffee, red apple	250 g £9.00, 1 kg £30.00
Hearthside	Dark (espresso)	Cocoa, molasses, toasted hazelnut	250 g £9.50, 1 kg £32.00
Slow Burn Decaf	Medium-dark (Swiss Water process)	Milk chocolate, caramel	250 g £10.00
Seasonal	Varies	Printed on the bag	250 g, price varies

Night Shift: our flagship

- Night Shift dark roast comes in a 250 g bag.
- Roasted every Monday in small batches.
- Tasting notes: dark chocolate, orange peel.
- Best within 30 days of roast.
- Available as whole bean, or ground for filter, cafetière or espresso.

Freshness

We roast every Monday. Orders placed by 11:00 on Monday ship that week, usually Tuesday or Wednesday. Nothing leaves the roastery more than 7 days after roasting. Every bag carries its roast date. We recommend drinking it within 30 days of that date.

Brewing equipment

Product	What it is	Price	Warranty
Hearth pour-over kit	Ceramic dripper, glass server, 50 filters	£38.00	1 year
Kindling hand grinder	Steel conical burr grinder, 30 grind settings	£65.00	2 years
Stoker gooseneck kettle	1 litre electric kettle with temperature control	£79.00	2 years

Packaging

Retail bags are kraft paper with a plant-based lining and a one-way valve. The 250 g bag is home-compostable in 26 weeks. The 1 kg bag is recyclable with soft plastics at supermarket drop-off points.

WARRANTY

Brewing equipment warranty

Ember brewing equipment comes with a manufacturer's warranty on top of your legal rights. This warranty does not affect your statutory rights under the Consumer Rights Act 2015.

What is covered

Product	Warranty period	Covers
Stoker gooseneck kettle	2 years from delivery	Heating element, base, temperature control, switch
Kindling hand grinder	2 years from delivery	Burrs, axle, bearings, body, adjustment ring
Hearth pour-over kit	1 year from delivery	Manufacturing faults in the dripper and server

The warranty covers faults in materials and workmanship that appear in normal home use within the warranty period. We will repair the item, replace it, or, if neither is possible, refund it.

What is not covered

- Accidental damage, drops, and cracks or chips in glass and ceramic after delivery.
- Damage from limescale. Descale the kettle monthly in hard-water areas.
- Normal wear, such as scratches, discoloured filters and worn grip coatings.
- Commercial use. Café use of home equipment is not covered.
- Repairs or modifications made by anyone other than Ember or our authorised repairer.
- Use with the wrong voltage or a non-UK plug adaptor.

How to claim

- Email warranty@embercoffee.example with your order number, a short description and a photo or video of the fault.
- We reply within 2 working days with a returns label at no cost to you.
- Once the item arrives, we inspect it and repair, replace or refund within 10 working days.
- A repaired or replaced item keeps the rest of the original warranty, or 90 days, whichever is longer.

Damaged on arrival

If anything arrives broken, tell us within 7 days with a photo of the item and the box. We send a replacement straight away and you do not need to return the broken one.

POLICIES

Delivery, returns, subscriptions and more

Delivery

Service	Time	Cost
UK standard (Royal Mail Tracked 48)	2 to 3 working days after dispatch	£3.95, free over £30
UK express (Tracked 24)	1 to 2 working days after dispatch	£5.95
Subscription	Ships the week of roasting	Free
Republic of Ireland and EU	4 to 8 working days	From £9.95, duties may apply

Returns and refunds

- Unopened coffee can be returned within 14 days of delivery for a full refund.
- Opened coffee cannot be returned for hygiene reasons, unless it is faulty. If you do not like a coffee, tell us and we will swap your next bag for a different roast, once per customer.
- Equipment can be returned unused, in its original packaging, within 30 days of delivery.
- Refunds go to the original payment method within 5 working days of receiving the return.
- Return postage is paid by you, unless the item is faulty or we sent the wrong thing.

Subscriptions

- Choose delivery every 1, 2 or 4 weeks. Change the roast, grind, size or date any time before Sunday 23:59.
- Pause for up to 12 weeks or cancel any time in your account. No minimum term, no cancellation fee.
- Subscribers save 10% on coffee and get free UK delivery.
- We charge your card on the Sunday before each roast. We email a reminder on the Friday before.

Privacy (summary)

We collect only what we need to take and deliver your order and run your account. We never sell your data. We send marketing emails only if you opt in, and every email has a one-click unsubscribe. The full privacy notice is at embercoffee.example/privacy.

Sustainability

We buy green coffee from three importers who publish the price paid at farm gate. We are not Fairtrade or organic certified and do not claim to be. We publish our farm-gate prices once a year. Coffee chaff from the roaster goes to a local allotment group for compost.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Terms of sale

1. Who we are. These terms apply to sales by Ember Coffee Co. Ltd, a company registered in England and Wales (company number 11845210), registered office Unit 4, Foundry Yard, Leeds LS9 8AB. VAT number GB 318 4471 26.

2. Your order. When you place an order, we email you to acknowledge it. The contract is formed when we email to confirm dispatch. We may decline an order, for example if an item is out of stock, and will refund you in full.

3. Prices and payment. Prices are in pounds sterling and include VAT. Delivery is charged as shown at checkout. We take payment when you place the order, or for subscriptions on the Sunday before each roast.

4. Delivery. We aim to deliver within the times on page 13 but these are estimates. Risk passes to you when the goods are delivered. If delivery is more than 30 days late you may cancel and get a full refund.

5. Your right to cancel. Under the Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013 you may cancel an order for equipment or unopened coffee within 14 days of delivery. Coffee that has been opened cannot be returned unless faulty, because it is perishable and sealed for hygiene.

6. Faulty goods. If goods are faulty you have rights under the Consumer Rights Act 2015, including a refund within 30 days of delivery, and repair or replacement after that. Our warranty on page 12 is in addition to these rights.

7. Subscriptions. A subscription continues until you cancel. You can cancel in your account or by email at any time before the Sunday charge for the next delivery. We may change subscription prices with 30 days' notice by email.

8. Promotions. Discount codes are single use unless stated, cannot be exchanged for cash and cannot be combined unless stated. We may end a promotion at any time without notice, but we will honour orders already placed.

9. Our liability. We are responsible for loss or damage you suffer that is a foreseeable result of our breach of these terms. We do not exclude liability for death or personal injury caused by our negligence, or for fraud. We are not liable for business losses; our products are for domestic use.

10. Events outside our control. We are not responsible for delays caused by events outside our reasonable control. If such an event lasts more than 30 days you may cancel and receive a refund for goods not delivered.

11. Changes to these terms. We may update these terms. The version in force when you place an order applies to that order.

12. Law and disputes. These terms are governed by the law of England and Wales. You may bring proceedings in the courts of England and Wales, or of Scotland or Northern Ireland if you live there. Contact us first at hello@embercoffee.example; we answer every complaint within 5 working days.

APPROVALS AND CONTACTS

Who signs off, and how to reach us

Sign-off

What	Who approves	Turnaround
Posters, ads and social campaigns	Brand team	2 working days
New product claims or facts	Brand team and head roaster	5 working days
Packaging	Brand team and operations	10 working days
Policy or terms changes	Operations director and legal adviser	10 working days
Partner co-branding	Founders	10 working days

Contacts

Team	Email	For
Brand	brand@embercoffee.example	This book, artwork, copy approval
Customer care	hello@embercoffee.example	Orders, subscriptions, complaints
Warranty	warranty@embercoffee.example	Equipment faults and claims
Wholesale	trade@embercoffee.example	Café accounts and training
Press	press@embercoffee.example	Media requests and images

Asset library

Logos (full colour, Crema and Roast Brown single colour), product photography, brew guides and font files are in the shared brand library. Ask the brand team for access. Please do not redraw, stretch, recolour or add effects to the logo.

Quick checklist before anything goes out

- Does it sound warm, playful and a little cheeky, and talk to one person?
- Is every fact on page 11, and every claim on page 7's allowed list?
- No cheap, fair trade, organic or world's best, anywhere?
- Colours exact, Ember Orange as the glow not the room?
- Poster copy within 6 / 12 / 25 words, and no words in the picture?
- Approved by the right person on this page?